Avacyn's Endless Night

Commander deck for Avacyn, Angel of Horror, built from Brad's "all cards" binder

The deck passes **deck:check** (100 cards, all owned from Brad's "all cards" binder, no proxies, unlimited Swamps), and the Archidekt and Moxfield decklist files are written beside it. It's set to **Bracket 3**. It has one Game Changer, Orcish Bowmasters, which is the only one in his pool, and no two-card combos, so it doesn't qualify for Bracket 4.

How Avacyn shaped the build

Whenever any nontoken creature you control dies, including Avacyn, she returns it to the battlefield at the beginning of the next end step. That changes three things:

- **Every creature should do something when it enters or dies.** You sacrifice it on your turn and it comes back at your end step. Sacrifice it again on each opponent's turn and its trigger fires once per player's turn.
- **Symmetrical effects become one-sided.** Accursed Marauder and Chain Devil make each player sacrifice a nontoken creature; yours comes back. Villainous Wrath and The Echoverse Fulcrum destroy all creatures, and your side returns.
- **Avacyn returns herself.** Let her go to the graveyard instead of the command zone and you never pay commander tax. Only exile or bounce really answers her, which is why Plaza of Heroes is in the deck (it gives her hexproof and indestructible).

Game plan

- **Engine:** free sacrifice outlets (Hammerhead, Umbral Collar Zealot, Unrooted Ancestor), outlets that draw (Kingpin's Enforcers, Ahriman, Skullport Merchant), and removal that sacrifices a creature as its cost (Worthy Cost, Embrace Oblivion, Stir Up Trouble). With Avacyn out, that cost is free.
- **Creatures to repeat:**
  - Removal: Azog, Elektra, Lamentation, Noxious Gearhulk, and Archive Arbiter for artifacts and enchantments.
  - Edicts: Voracious Fell Beast and Winter.
  - Drains: Gollum the Abandoned, Vampire Spawn, and Cat-Gator, which deals damage equal to your Swamp count every time it enters.
  - Discard: Hecteyes and Tinybones.
  - Value: Grim Servant tutors every time it enters, Ravenloft Adventurer takes the initiative, and Doctor Doom makes two 3/3 tokens.
- **Payoffs:** Agent Venom draws a card on every nontoken death, and Massacre Girl and Al Bhed Salvagers drain on deaths.
- **Mana:** 37 lands (34 Swamps) and about 13 real ramp pieces: The Soul Stone, mana rocks, Troop of Ponies and Treasure makers. deck:stats gives an average mana value of 3.08 and suggests

about 38.6 lands. The deck runs one under because there are also about five Treasures from creature deaths.

Weaknesses

- **No fast mana.** Avacyn costs 8 and the deck has no 1-2 mana rocks besides The Soul Stone. Expect to cast her around turn 6-7.
- **Weak without Avacyn.** Before she lands it plays as a decent value deck; the loops need her on the battlefield.
- **Few artifact and enchantment answers:** only Archive Arbiter and Withering Torment.
- **Exile and graveyard hate** shut down her returns.

What would make it stronger

The best black aristocrats cards Brad owns are all protected in his other decks: Blood Artist, Zulaport Cutthroat, Viscera Seer, Carrion Feeder, Gray Merchant, Skullclamp, Sol Ring, Arcane Signet, Dark Ritual, Bastion of Remembrance and Butcher of Malakir. If he's willing to pull some out of those decks, or buy copies, they're the biggest single upgrade. Purchase targets beyond those would be Phyrexian Altar, Ashnod's Altar, Cabal Coffers and Urborg, Crypt Ghast, Grave Pact and Pitiless Plunderer.

With a budget, these can be added as upgrade swaps and priced. That needs a card-data refresh from Scryfall first.